FAIRPLANE

Guided city tours

Based on ten customer interviews and observations from the Fairplane Guided City Tours team

SCENARIO

Browsing, booking, attending, and rating a local city tour

Entice
How does someone initially become aware of this process?

Enter
What do people experience as they begin the process?

Engage
In the core moments in the process, what happens?

Exit
What do people typically experience as the process finishes?

Extend
What happens after the experience is over?

Steps
What does the person (or group) typically experience?

Entice
- **Booking other travel** — Most customers discover city tours as they are booking other Fairplane travel
- **Visit website or app** — A customer navigates to the city tours section of our website or app
- **Choose a city, dates, and number of people** — The customer types in a city, dates, and the number of people who will attend the tour to ensure tickets are available
- **Browse available tours** — The customer sees available tours for their dates, city, and number of people
- **View detail on a single tour** — After seeing a tour that interests them, the customer clicks on the tour to view the tour's detail page. The detail page includes a description of the tour, a map of the tour route, photos, and a calendar showing the tour's availability

Enter
- **Start purchase of a tour** — After deciding to go on this tour, they click the Purchase button
- **Complete payment information** — They fill out their contact and credit card information, then continue
- **Confirm payment & book tour** — They see a summary of what they are about to purchase, then they confirm and the tour is booked
- **Email confirmation** — An email immediately sends to confirm their tour and provide details about where and when to meet their guide
- **Email reminder** — Two day before the tour begins, a reminder email is sent to all tour participants. The email includes a reminder of the tour, a phone number to contact the tour guide, and a map of the meeting location

Engage
- **Arrive at tour location** — Using their own means of transportation, the customer makes their way to the meeting location as the scheduled time
- **Meet the guide & group** — Tour participants meet their guide and other people who have joined the same tour
- **Experience the tour** — The guide brings the group around the area, explaining things as they go. Typically, this lasts 2 hours

Exit
- **Leave the guide & group** — The guide wraps up the tour and everyone breaks their separate ways
- **Prompt for review** — One hour after the tour finishes, an email and in-app notification prompt the tour participant for a review
- **Writing & submitting review** — The tour participant writes a review and gives the tour a star-rating out of 5.

Extend
- **Tour appears in the user profile** — The completed tour appears in the "tour history" section of a customer's profile. Customers can review the experience (whether they great such
- **Personalized recommendations** — Participation in the tour results in a personalized recommendation system. The system learns from the experience (whether they great such
- **Personalized tour offers** — The customer receives an email to drop other things and with pre-scheduled recommendations for other tours
- **Personalized tour recommendations after tour-based booking** — When a partner tour participant books a tour based with us, we offer them personalized tour recommendations in their emails

Interactions
What interactions do they have at each step along the way?

- **People:** Who do they see or talk to?
- **Places:** Where are they?
- **Things:** What digital touchpoints or physical objects would they use?

Entice
- Travel booking section of the website, iOS app, or Android app
- City tours section of the website, iOS app, or Android app
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  - The tour guide makes first appearance of the point, although the customer doesn't interact with them yet.

Enter
- City tours section of the website, iOS app, or Android app
- Payment overlay within the website, iOS app, or Android app
- Payment overlay within the website, iOS app, or Android app
- Customer's email (software like Outlook or website tour Email)
- Customer's email (software like Outlook or website tour Email)

Engage
- Tour locations tend to exist in unpopulated public areas, so there is little or no people in the tour area
  - The customer looks for the tour guide, who is often in a distinctive way (they walk closer)
- Direct interactions with the guide, and potentially other group members
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  - Some tours include interactions with shopkeepers or restaurant staff (e.g. on a food-oriented tour)
  - Most common objects people interact with on tours are bikes, Segways, food, and souvenirs

Exit
- Direct interactions with the guide, and potentially other group members
  - Often takes place at the same place where the tour started and the guide, but not always
  - Depending on the tour participant and guide, tipping/cash may be involved
- Customer's email (software like Outlook or website tour Email)
- "Leave a review" modal window within the profile section of the website, iOS app, or Android app
  - To some degree, this is a social interaction with the tour guide, who will see their review

Extend
- Completed experiences section of the profile on the website, iOS app, or Android app
  - If other users interact with the tour, they may also see items recommended tours elsewhere
- Recommendations spur across website, iOS app, or Android app
- Customer's email (software like Outlook or website tour Email)
- Post-purchase screens website, iOS app, or Android app

Goals & motivations
At each step, what is a person's primary goal or motivation? ("Help me..." or "Help me avoid...")

Entice
- Help me get this flight or hotel booked
- Help me have more fun or learn new things on my trip
- Help me avoid seeing tours for the wrong dates, locations, or numbers of people
- Help me see what they have to offer
- Help me understand what this tour is all about

Enter
- Help me commit to going on this tour
- Help me get through this payment pad without too much hassle
- Help me feel confident about my payment pad finished and tell me what to do next
- Help me feel confident about my tour being finished and tell me what to do next
- Help me make sure I don't forget about my tour so that I don't waste money or get disappointed

Engage
- Help me feel confident about the tour guide I should look for (if there are people in my guide
- Help me feel good about my decision to go on this tour and to feel satisfied
- Help me make the most of my trip to this new place

Exit
- Help me leave the tour with good feelings and no awkwardness
- Help me spread the word about my experience, provide constructive and feedback the one that was not so good.

Extend
- Help me see what I've done before
- Help me see what I could be doing next
- Help me see ways to restoration my new trip

Positive moments
What steps does a typical person find enjoyable, productive, fun, motivating, delightful, or exciting?

Entice
- It's fun to look at options and imagine doing each tour, for shopping for experiences
- Tour photos, videos, and explanations are exciting to see
  - It's reassuring to and reviews written by past travelers

Enter
- Excitement about the purchase ("Hooray we got")
- Current payment flow is very bare-bones and simple
- We've heard from several people that the customer emails more important, and more exciting than expected, e.g. in advance

Engage
- Our guides tend to be so good that people are reassured when they travel their guide
- People love the tour itself, we have a 98% satisfaction rating

Exit
- People generally leave tours feeling refreshed and inspired

Extend
- People like looking back on their past trips
- We think people like these recommendations because they are extremely high engagement rate

Negative moments
What steps does a typical person find frustrating, confusing, angering, costly, or time-consuming?

Entice
- Purpose sometimes forget to put in their dates or number of people, and then they get a distinct from they could actually decide
- General people expressed "information overload" on they browsed
- People express a lot of fear of commitment at this step

Enter
- Trepidation about the purchase ("I hope this will be worth it")

Engage
- People expressed embarrassment about finding their guide in a public place
- Sometimes people are matched up with tour participants that they don't really like

Exit
- People are unclear whether a tip is necessary, especially for non-Americans on an American tour
  - Review tool pest pressure to write a review, especially after a lot of time has passed (e.g. 2 weeks after tour ended and much more than 24 hours after tour ended)
- Customers report feeling review fatigue
  - We have very low review rates (e.g. 1 review per 10 reviews requested over several hours)
- People describe leaving a review as an arduous process

Areas of opportunity
How might we make each step better? What ideas do we have? What have others suggested?

Entice
- If you don't follow this path immediately after your booking, could we send a follow up?
- Could we automatically carry over the city from your booking? (e.g. via a cookie)
- Make it easier to compare and shop for experiences without having to click on them
- Provide a simpler summary to avoid information overload
  - Show highlights or common phrases from reviews, so that people can "scan-read" the gist

Enter

Engage
- How might we make our guides easier to identify (use a distinctive hat or shirt color, for example)?

Exit
- How might we make it easier for people to leave a review (and feel encouraged)?
  - How might we nudge people to tip after the tour? (e.g. via Venmo or equivalent app)
  - How might we initially educate this web-based movement?
- Could we (& Wren) provide incentives for people who actually give a response rate)?
- How might we progressively disclose the full review so that each step looks more natural?

Extend
- How might we help customers remember everything things they've taken in the past?
- How might we extend the personal connection to the guide long after the tour is over?